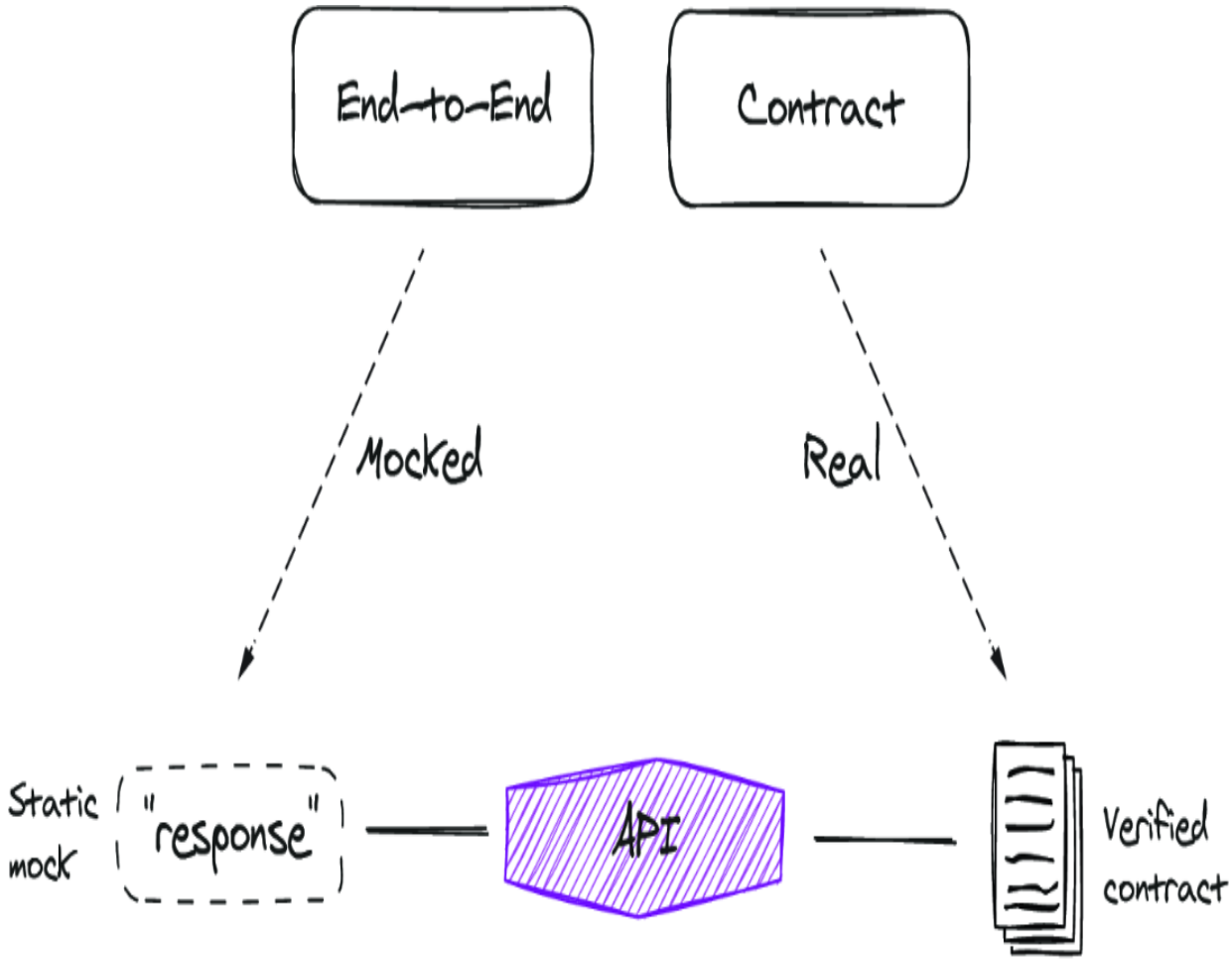


Figure 12.5 E2E tests are mocked, whereas contract tests use the real API provider to retain test coverage and increase reliability.

Contract tests support E2E tests to reduce flakiness and running time to execute the tests. If an E2E test checked an error scenario with an actual integrated endpoint, that would sometimes be unavailable due to a service outage. Ideally, this test would be moved down the test pyramid to a lower-level test using a mocked response. Introducing a mocked response as part of the E2E test will improve the test's stability but reduce its validity. Then, adding a contract test to check the isolated integration error scenario will enhance the validity with no risk of flakiness. Say we have a Cypress scenario that checks GitHub's search results website (www.github.com), as shown in listing 12.7. The Cypress test navigates to the GitHub website, where the web app sends a request to the `"/search/suggestions"` API endpoint while typing into the search box. The assertion for this test checks the relative URL `href` attribute.